Zachary Gooch

Florida State University | Department of Economics
zg23a@fsu.edu | (404) 245-3713
LinkedIn | Personal Website
Tallahassee, FL

Fields of Interest

Public Economics, Labor Economics, Economics of Education

Education

Florida State University Tallahassee, FL
Ph.D., Economics (Expected May 2028)
Committee: Shawn Kantor (chair), Luke Rodgers, Carl Kitchens
M.S., Economics, December 2024

Georgia College & State University Milledgeville, GA
B.S., Economics (Magna Cum Laude), May 2023

Working Papers

Performance Pay at Scale: Evidence from Texas's Statewide Teacher Incentive Program
Draft available upon request.

Works in Progress

Examining the Long-Run Effects of Voluntary Prekindergarten (with Luke P. Rodgers)

Regulating Evidence: How the 1962 Efficacy Requirement Reshaped Pharmaceutical Knowledge Production and Scientific Careers (with Shawn Kantor and Alexander Whalley)

Retrenchment at the Blackboard: How Economic Crises Reshape the Teacher Labor Market (with Michael Darisse)

Public Presence and Crime: Evidence from NYC (with Colin Adams and Samuel Herrin)

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record, Florida State University
Principles of Macroeconomics Summer 2025
Instructor rating: 4.91/5.00 (73% response rate)
Intermediate Macroeconomics Summer 2026
Instructor rating: 4.93/5.00 (83% response rate)
Teaching Assistant, Florida State University
Introduction to Econometrics Spring 2024, Spring 2025
Principles of Microeconomics and Macroeconomics Fall 2023 – Spring 2025

Research Assistantships

Research Assistant for Shawn Kantor, Florida State University Fall 2025 – Present

- Co-author on a research project in economic history.
- Construct novel datasets from the universe of historical patent records and drug industry sources; responsibilities span data construction, empirical analysis, and research design.

Honors, Scholarships, and Fellowships

- Baugh Doctoral Fellowship, Florida State University 2023 – Present
- Charles E. Rockwood Award for Excellence in Teaching Summer 2025
- Richard and Ellen Sandor Award for Excellence in Economics Spring 2026
- Research Grant, Institute for Governance and Civics, FSU ($5,000) Spring 2026
  For restricted-data access through the Texas Education Research Center

Seminar Presentations

- FSU Quantitative Economics Workshop, Tallahassee, FL Spring 2026
- South Carolina Economic Policy Center PhD Symposium, Columbia, SC Spring 2026

Computational Skills

R, Stata, Python, LaTeX

References

Shawn Kantor
L. Charles Hilton Jr. Distinguished Professor, Florida State University
skantor@fsu.edu

Luke Rodgers
Associate Professor, Florida State University
lprodgers@fsu.edu

Carl Kitchens
Professor, Florida State University
ckitchens@fsu.edu

Last updated: October 19, 2026